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r/Authentik • 8mo ago
kovalr

Nginx Proxy Manager returns 500 Internal Server Error

My aim is to integrate Nginx Proxy Manager with Authentik using Forward auth.

Both instances installed on a separate hosts.

Authentik URL: <https://authentik.mydomain.com>

Static site behind Nginx Proxy Manager : <https://static.mydomain.com>

A lot of videos and tutorials show how to integrate it when Authentik and Nginx Proxy Manager are running on the same machine inside the same Docker network. But in my case, they are running on separate machines.

I used this video:

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vwBiffaPI1E>

And also read this article:

<https://joshroll.com/implementing-sso-using-authentik-and-nginx-reverse-proxy-manager/>

What I did:

In **Applications** section I added new application nginx.

Search...	×	Q	Create with Provider	Create	Refresh	Clear cache	Delete
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☐	Name ↑	Group ↓	Provider	Provider Type	Actions		
☐	N	nginx	-	Provider for nginx	Proxy Provider		

In **Providers** section I added new provider named `Provider for nginx` and configured external hosts to the <https://static.mydomain.com>

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Name *

Provider for nginx

Authorization flow *

default-provider-authorization-explicit-consent (Authorize Application)

Flow used when authorizing this provider.

Proxy

Forward auth (single application)

Forward auth (domain level)

Use this provider with nginx's auth_request or traefik's forwardAuth. Each application/domain needs its own provider. Additionally, on each domain, /outpost.goauthentik.io must be routed to the outpost (when using a managed outpost, this is done for you).

External host *

https://[REDACTED]/

The external URL you'll access the application at. Include any non-standard port.

Token validity *

hours=24

Configure how long tokens are valid for.

> Advanced protocol settings

Update

Cancel

In **Outposts** I added **nginx** from the **Available Applications** to **Selected Applications**

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Name *

Type *

Proxy

Integration

Local Docker connection

Selecting an integration enables the management of the outpost by authentik.
[See documentation.](#)

Applications

Available Applications

nginx

Provider for nginx ✓

Selected Applications

1 item(s) selected.

nginx

Provider for nginx

Update

Cancel

Then I clicked on **Provider for nginx** and choose configuration form the **Nginx (Proxy Manager) tab**.

Here what I got:

```
# Increase buffer size for large headers
# This is needed only if you get 'upstream sent too big header while reading response
# header from upstream' error when trying to access an application protected by goauthentik
proxy_buffers 8 16k;
proxy_buffer_size 32k;

# Make sure not to redirect traffic to a port 4443
port_in_redirect off;

location / {
    # Put your proxy_pass to your application here
    proxy_pass          $forward_scheme://$server:$port;
    # Set any other headers your application might need
    # proxy_set_header Host $host;
    # proxy_set_header ...
    # Support for websocket
    proxy_set_header Upgrade $http_upgrade;
    proxy_set_header Connection $http_connection;
    proxy_http_version 1.1;
```

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```
#####
auth_request      /outpost.goauthentik.io/auth/nginx;
error_page        401 = u/goauthentik_proxy_signin;
auth_request_set  $auth_cookie $upstream_http_set_cookie;
add_header        Set-Cookie $auth_cookie;

# translate headers from the outposts back to the actual upstream
auth_request_set  $authentik_username $upstream_http_x_authentik_username;
auth_request_set  $authentik_groups $upstream_http_x_authentik_groups;
auth_request_set  $authentik_entitlements $upstream_http_x_authentik_entitlements;
auth_request_set  $authentik_email $upstream_http_x_authentik_email;
auth_request_set  $authentik_name $upstream_http_x_authentik_name;
auth_request_set  $authentik_uid $upstream_http_x_authentik_uid;

proxy_set_header  X-authentik-username $authentik_username;
proxy_set_header  X-authentik-groups $authentik_groups;
proxy_set_header  X-authentik-entitlements $authentik_entitlements;
proxy_set_header  X-authentik-email $authentik_email;
proxy_set_header  X-authentik-name $authentik_name;
proxy_set_header  X-authentik-uid $authentik_uid;

# This section should be uncommented when the "Send HTTP Basic authentication" option
# is enabled in the proxy provider
# auth_request_set $authentik_auth $upstream_http_authorization;
# proxy_set_header Authorization $authentik_auth;
}

# all requests to /outpost.goauthentik.io must be accessible without authentication
location /outpost.goauthentik.io {
    # When using the embedded outpost, use:
    proxy_pass      http://authentik.company:9000/outpost.goauthentik.io;
    # For manual outpost deployments:
    # proxy_pass      http://outpost.company:9000;

    # Note: ensure the Host header matches your external authentik URL:
    proxy_set_header      Host $host;

    proxy_set_header      X-Original-URL $scheme://$http_host$request_uri;
    add_header             Set-Cookie $auth_cookie;
    auth_request_set        $auth_cookie $upstream_http_set_cookie;
    proxy_pass_request_body off;
    proxy_set_header        Content-Length "";
}

# Special location for when the /auth endpoint returns a 401,
# redirect to the /start URL which initiates SSO
```

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```
return 302 /outpost.goauthentik.io/start?rd=$scheme://$http_host$request_uri;  
# For domain level, use the below error_page to redirect to your authentik server with the full  
# return 302 https://authentik.company/outpost.goauthentik.io/start?rd=$scheme://$http_host$request_uri;  
}
```

In this configuration I changed

```
proxy_pass          http://authentik.company:9000/outpost.goauthentik.io;
```

to

```
proxy_pass          https://authentik.mydomain.com/outpost.goauthentik.io;
```

Then I open NPM, and pasted my config in to the **Custom Nginx Configuration**

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[⚡ Details](#) [📁 Custom locations](#) [🛡 SSL](#) [⚙ Advanced](#)

These proxy details are available as nginx variables:

- `$server` Forward Hostname / IP
- `$port` Forward Port
- `$forward_scheme` Scheme

Custom Nginx Configuration

```
# Increase buffer size for large headers
# This is needed only if you get 'upstream sent too big header
while reading response
# header from upstream' error when trying to access an
application protected by goauthentik
proxy_buffers 8 16k;
proxy_buffer_size 32k;
```

⚠ Please note, that any `add_header` or `set_header` directives added here will not be used by nginx. You will have to add a custom location `'/'` and add the header in the custom config there.

[Cancel](#)[Save](#)

After this I opened <https://static.mydomain.com> and got

500 Internal Server Error

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When I check outpost url with **Curl**

```
curl -v https://authentik.mydomain.com/outpost.goauthentik.io/ping
```

It returns: < HTTP/2 204

I need advice on how to debug and fix the issue.



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skordogs1 • 8mo ago

I would suggest removing the trailing / from your forward auth and changing the advanced settings in your npm host to use the ip address and port instead of your domain for proxy_pass. Using my domain never works for me but I never have problems with the ip address. Works with either http and 9000 or https and 9443 or whatever ports you're using.



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[Reply](#)kovalr **OP** • 8mo ago

-> and changing the advanced settings in your npm host to use the ip address and port instead of your domain for proxy_pass.

Well, this part is hard to do, because my <https://authentik.mydomain.com> is behind Cloudflare. I'm not sure if Cloudflare allows using an IP address instead of a URL.



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proxy_buffers 4 32k; proxy_busy_buffers_size 64k; fastcgi_buffers 16 16k; fastcgi_buffer_size 32k;

↑ 1 ↓ [Reply](#) ...



heisian • 5mo ago • Edited 5mo ago

You can't `proxy_pass` a public URL, NGINX only knows how to proxy IP addresses or things that don't require a DNS lookup (i.e., `localhost`). At least, that's the best explanation I can think of, but it seems to be wrong. Someone smarter please correct me... ANYWAYS, read on:

HOW TO FIX THIS

You need to enter in the *LOCAL* IP address of your Authentik server <http://192.168.1.12:9000> instead of <https://authentik.mydomain.com> in your `location /outpost.goauthentik.io` `proxy_pass` entry:

```
location /outpost.goauthentik.io {
    # When using the embedded outpost, use:
    proxy_pass          http://192.168.1.12:9000/outpost.goauthentik.io;
```

Then, in your Authentik server Outpost Advanced Settings (Applications > Outposts > Edit authentik Embedded Outpost > Advanced Settings), make sure your `authentik_host` is set to `https://authentik.mydomain.com`.

Outpost configuration in Advanced Settings:

```
log_level: info
docker_labels: null
authentik_host: https://authentik.mydomain.com/
docker_network: null
container_image: null
```

Doing the above **FINALLY** made it work for me after fudging/debugging/error logging for an hour. AI was useless, of course, so I had to resort to good 'ol searching, reading, stack overflow etc.

P.S., You may also need to add these headers to your `location /` block to get your app to load all the stylesheets, javascript, etc., with the correct protocol and URL:

```
# Set any other headers your application might need
proxy_set_header Host $host;
proxy_set_header X-Real-IP $remote_addr;
```



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